

THE FIRST FRENCH REPUBLIC

*The Republic is teetering,
and the citizens look for a leader.*



RULEBOOK

3–6 players · ages 12 and up

The New Republic 20–30 min · The National Convention 30–40 min

À PARIS · DE L'IMPRIMERIE DE LA CONVENTION

ÉDITION D'ESSAI · L'AN II · TIRAGE VIII

PAPIER VERGÉ · BLEU, BLANC, ROUGE

THE TALE



The King is dead and the Republic is one year old. In the hall of the Convention the four factions: the **Montagnards** on the high benches, **La Plaine** in the marsh below them, the **Girondins** of the departments, and the **Royalists** who do not say their name, send their deputies onto the floor.

Each citizen marches deputies along the paths of the devise: **Liberté, Égalité, Fraternité**, and, when the hour is dark enough, **...ou la Mort**. A deputy takes the floor on its own card, but marches furthest on the strength lent to it by rivals. When one reaches the end of a path, the rival who lent the most decides which faction takes the vote, and the citizen whose deputy it was takes the action.

But no citizen can read their own **Élan**, the measure of their standing, plain to every eye but their own. So the deputies trade, deceive, and denounce, each hoping to shine brightest when the floor is finally carried.

“To the citizen whose Élan burns brightest in the faction that calls the Coup, to that citizen is granted the Republic.”

OVERVIEW



OBJECTIVE

Have the highest **Élan** in the faction where a player Calls for a Coup d'État.

Each player has a secret **Faction** card (their allegiance) and an **Élan** card, a number visible to every other player but not to its owner. Players move **Deputies** along the paths. Completing one grants you an action, and seats a **Vote** that your strongest backer places. You choose where your deputies go; a rival chooses what their arrival is worth.

When a faction holds 7 or more Votes, a player completing a path may **Call for a Coup d'État** in that faction. Seating a **9th** Vote in a faction triggers a Call automatically.

If a Call resolves, all players reveal their Faction and Élan cards: **the highest Élan player who belongs to the faction where the Call happened wins the game.**

THE TWO GAMES



The New Republic (Base Game): three paths, Liberté, Égalité and Fraternité.

The National Convention (Full Game): adds ...ou la Mort, its deputy actions, and the Bribe.

Rules marked ♦ apply to The National Convention only. Play The New Republic first.

THE PIECES

Board · 1

Four paths, four factions.

Élan cards · 9

Numbered 1–9, all unique. Yours faces away from you.

Support cards · 36

Numbered 1–6, one hand per player.

Deputies · 18

Wooden figures, up to 3 per player.

Player aids · 6

The turn, the actions, and the order of play.

Faction cards · 16

4 per faction. Your secret allegiance.

Card stands · 6

One per player; holds your Élan card facing away.

Abstention cards · 6

One per player. Backs no one, and is spent all the same.

Votes · 36

Cockade markers. Faction markers.



Montagnards
the high benches



La Plaine
the marsh

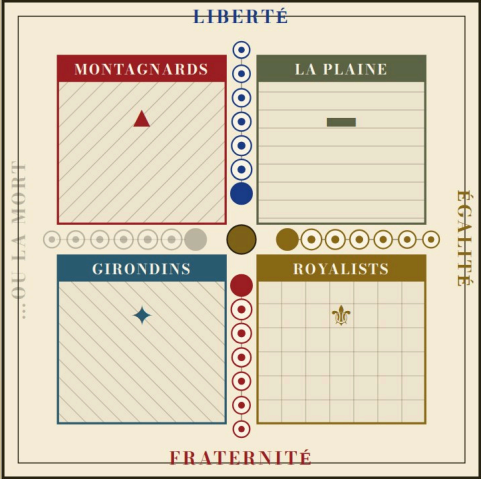


Girondins
the departments



Royalists
the pretender

SETUP



The floor at the opening. ...ou la Mort is dark; it is used only in The National Convention.

1. Shuffle the Faction and Élan decks separately. Place them face down beside the board with the Votes.
2. Each player takes **1 Faction card** (look at it; keep it hidden), **1 Élan card** placed **facing away** in a card stand without looking at it, the **6 Support cards**, **1 Abstention card**, and **2 Deputies** kept in a reserve.
3. Every faction begins with no votes. Leave the four quarters empty.
4. **The New Republic:** ...ou la Mort is not used. ♦ **The National Convention:** it is in play.
5. Choose a start player at random. Play proceeds clockwise.
6. Before the first turn, **everyone secretly prepares one card face down**. That is the card you will play when your turn comes.

YOUR TURN

TAKE THE FLOOR

Turn your **prepared card** face up. Every rival now secretly commits one card to you, a Support card or their Abstention. All of the committed cards are revealed **at the same moment**.

You move steps equal to **your own card plus the single highest card committed to you**. Every committed card is spent, backing you or not. The rival whose card was highest is your **backer**; if two tie, you choose.

MOVEMENT

- Divide the steps between your Deputies in any order.
- A Deputy moves 1 spot per step, always forward, never back.
- Entering play from your reserve costs 1 step, onto any path's **first spot**.
- Spots are never blocked; Deputies may share one. Unspent steps are lost.
- ♦ **Borrowed steps**, those from your backer's card, may not be spent on **...ou la Mort**. Only your own card marches there.

COMPLETING A PATH

When a Deputy ends a step on a path's **seventh spot**, resolve in this order:

1. A **Vote is seated**. On the first path you complete this turn, **your backer** chooses the faction. On any later one, **you** choose. If every rival abstained, no vote is seated.
2. Take **one** of that path's actions (p. 6), or **Call for a Coup d'État** (p. 5).
3. Return the Deputy to your reserve.

Your turn then ends by **preparing one card face down**. This is not optional. ♦ At that same moment you may **Bribe** (p. 7).

WHEN THE HAND RUNS DRY

Cards are spent, not discarded to a pile you draw from. When you have spent every card you hold, your **whole hand returns to you at once**: the six Support cards and the Abstention alike.

EXAMPLE

Alix prepared a 4 and turns it face up. Blaise commits a 5, Camille a 2, Dominique their **Abstention**; all three flip together. The highest is Blaise's 5, so Alix moves $4 + 5 = 9$ steps and Blaise is her backer. The 2 and the Abstention are spent for nothing.

Her Deputy stands on the 1st spot of Fraternité; six steps carry it to the seventh and complete the path. **Blaise** seats the vote with the Girondins. Alix takes Fraternité's action and looks at Dominique's Faction card. Her Deputy returns to her reserve.

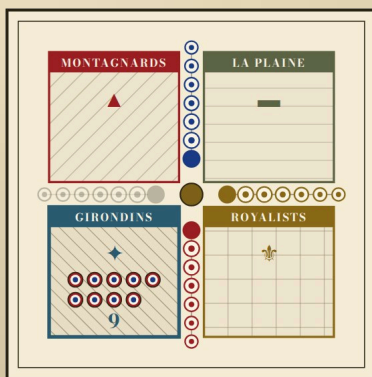
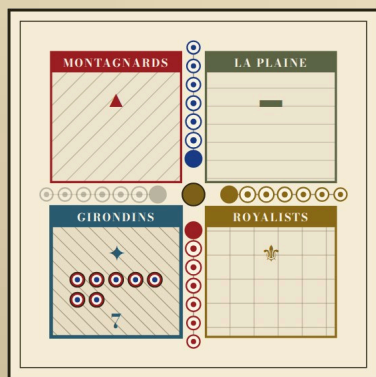
With her last 3 steps her second Deputy enters Liberté (1 step) and moves 2 spots forward. She prepares a card face down, and her turn ends.

HOW TO WIN

CALL FOR A COUP D'ÉTAT

As the session goes on, more Votes gather in the factions. When a player completes a path and the faction reaches **7 Votes**, they may **Call for a Coup d'État** there rather than taking that path's action. If the Call resolves, everyone reveals their Faction and Élan cards.

The player with the highest Élan, who belongs to the faction where the Call happened, wins!



7 or more Votes gather in a faction: a player completing a path may **Call** there, instead of taking an action.

A 9th Vote enters a faction: a Coup happens there immediately, no matter who seated it.

There is no interrupt. A Coup that is called **resolves**. No card answers it and no rival may cancel it. The only defence is to have moved the votes before it came: see **The Bribe** (p. 7). The Call is won by the highest Élan belonging to the called faction, **whether or not they made the Call**.

EXAMPLE • A COUP AT 7 VOTES

Alix completes Égalité. The Girondins hold 6 votes, and her backer seats the seventh there. Instead of taking an action, she **Calls** for a Coup among the Girondins.

Everyone reveals. Blaise serves the Girondins with Élan **8**; Alix serves them too, with Élan **3**, a number she had never seen. **Blaise wins**, though Alix made the Call.

EXAMPLE • A REVOLUTION AT 9 VOTES

Later in another session, Camille completes Liberté and her backer seats a **9th** vote with the Montagnards. A Coup happens there at once. Nobody chose it, and nobody may decline it.

Everyone reveals. Only Dominique serves the Montagnards. **Dominique wins** without ever having called for anything.

THE ACTIONS

Completing a path grants one action from that path, or a Call in its place.

Liberté ÉLAN ACTIONS

- **Swap Élan** with a rival. You take the card you can already read on their stand; each of you places the received card facing away.
- **Look at your own Élan**, then return it facing away.

Égalité VOTE ACTIONS

- **Sway a vote** from one faction to another.
- **Recall 2 votes** from any faction or factions. They are struck off the rolls entirely.

Fraternité FACTION ACTIONS

- **Swap Factions** with a rival. You trade allegiance cards, and both of you see the exchange.
- **Look at a rival's Faction** card, in secret.

◆ ...ou la Mort DEPUTY ACTIONS

- **Seat a vote** yourself, in any faction you choose.
- **Recruit a Deputy** into your service. No one may hold more than 3.
- **Imprison a Deputy** out of a rival's service. No one may be left with fewer than 1.

◆ COMPLETING ...OU LA MORT

The army disbands: your **whole hand returns to you at once**, spent cards and all, in addition to the action you take.

THE HAND

Six Support cards numbered **1 to 6**, and one **Abstention**. There is no draw pile. Every card you will ever hold is known to you from the first turn.

- **On your own turn** the card you prepared last turn is what you move with, chosen before you knew what the floor would look like.
- **On a rival's turn** you commit one card to them, face down, revealed with everyone else's. It is spent whether or not it backs them.
- **The Abstention** commits nothing and backs no one, and is spent exactly like any other card. You hold only one all game.
- **When your hand is empty**, every card you have spent returns to you at once.

WHY A CARD IS NEVER WASTED

A card committed to a rival who does not need it is still gone from your hand. Feeding the floor is how you empty your hand, and emptying your hand is how you get it back.

◆ THE NATIONAL CONVENTION

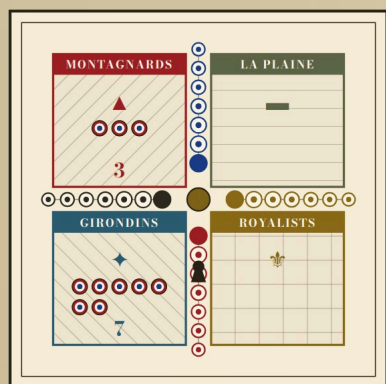
Play as the base game, with these changes:

1. **...ou la Mort is in play:** a fourth path of seven spots, granting Deputy actions.
2. **Borrowed steps may not be spent there.** Only your own prepared card marches on ...ou la Mort; a backer's card cannot carry you down it.
3. **Completing it returns your whole hand** to you at once.
4. **The Bribe** is available to every player, below.

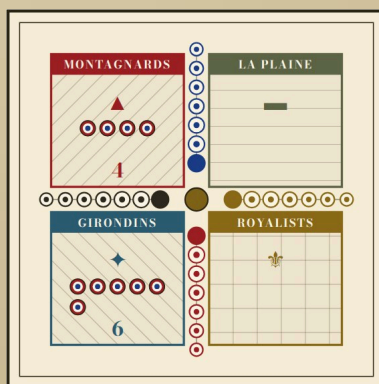
THE BRIBE

At the moment you prepare your card for next turn, and at no other time, you may **denounce one of your own Deputies** to carry a single Vote from one faction to another.

- The Deputy may be one **standing on a path** or one **waiting in your reserve**.
- That Deputy is **imprisoned** and does not come back. Whatever ground it had made is lost with it. You may recruit a replacement on **...ou la Mort**.
- You may never fall below **one Deputy**.
- You still owe a prepared card. Bribing does not end your turn, and the board you commit against may be the one you have just changed.



Before. The Girondins stand at coup strength, and your deputy is five spots along Fraternité.



After. A vote crosses to the Montagnards. The deputy, and the five spots it had made, are lost.

WHY IT HURTS

A vote is never created or destroyed by a Bribe; it only changes hands. What you spend is a Deputy, and with it whatever ground that Deputy had made. Recruiting on ...ou la Mort is the only way to replace one, so most citizens have exactly one Bribe in them for the whole session.

FAQ

Every rival abstained on my turn. What happens?

You move with your own card alone, nobody is your backer, and no vote is seated on the path you complete. The abstentions are still spent.

Two rivals committed the same highest card.

You choose which of them is your backer, and therefore which of them seats the vote.

Can I look at my own Élan?

Only through Liberté's action, or by taking a rival's card in a swap. Otherwise it faces away from you for the whole session.

I completed two paths in one turn. Who seats the second vote?

You do. Your backer seats only the first.

No player belongs to the called faction. Who wins?

No one. Not a citizen stood with them, and the Republic is left with no master. The session ends.

My hand is empty and it is my turn.

Every card you have spent returns at once, Abstention included, before you play.

Can I refuse to prepare a card?

No. Your turn ends by preparing one, and it must be a card you hold.

◆ Can I Bribe with a Deputy in my reserve?

Yes. It costs you no ground, only the Deputy itself. Recruit a replacement on ...ou la Mort.

◆ May I Bribe down to no Deputies?

No. You must always keep at least one.

THE ORDER OF A TURN

- I Turn your prepared card face up.
- II Every rival secretly commits one card to you. All are revealed together.
- III The single highest committed card is your backer's. Ties are broken by you. Every committed card is spent.
- IV Move: your own card + the highest committed card. ◆ Borrowed steps may not go down ...ou la Mort.
- V On each completed path: seat a vote, the first by your backer and any later by you, then take an action, or Call for a Coup d'État.
- VI Prepare one card face down. ◆ You may Bribe at this moment, and only at this moment.

A LONGER SESSION

Experienced groups, or large ones, may raise the threshold before setup. Choose a number from **8 to 12**: players may Call when a faction reaches that many Votes, and a Coup happens automatically when the faction gains 2 more.